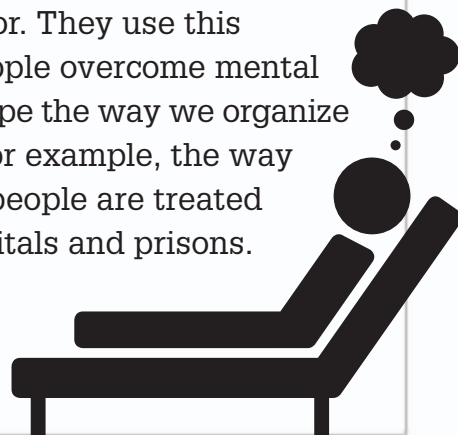




PSYCHOLOGIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Psychologists apply scientific methods to analyze and explain human behavior. They use this understanding to help people overcome mental health problems, or to shape the way we organize many areas of society—for example, the way we are taught, and how people are treated and rehabilitated in hospitals and prisons. Specialty branches of psychology require special training.



SALARY

Bachelor's graduate ★★★★★

Doctoral graduate ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Large sector • Growing demand for psychologists as new areas of expertise develop • Most jobs in educational services, health care, and social service

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Psychology • English • Biology • Mathematics (especially statistics) • Helping and caring for people



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Graduate-level qualifications are required; you will usually need to be licensed in order to practice.



LIFESTYLE Depending on their specialty, psychologists usually work normal office hours. If employed in a hospital, they may work shifts.



LOCATION Psychologists usually see clients in an office or clinic, but they may also be expected to make visits to homes or institutions.



THE REALITIES The job can be emotionally stressful. In some branches of the profession, a psychologist can be on call for long periods of time.

CAREER PATHS

You will need a minimum of a bachelor's degree to enter the profession. With relevant work experience, you can then study for a higher degree that will enable you to specialize in an area, from clinical to organizational psychology.

BACHELOR'S GRADUATE

With a degree in psychology, you can work in many educational, rehabilitation, or health care settings, or as a research assistant.



GRADUATE To qualify as a psychologist, you generally need a doctoral degree in psychology and a license to practice. Master's degrees holders can be licensed in many of the same fields, but they are not called psychologists.

